DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

OVERVIEW Week 8

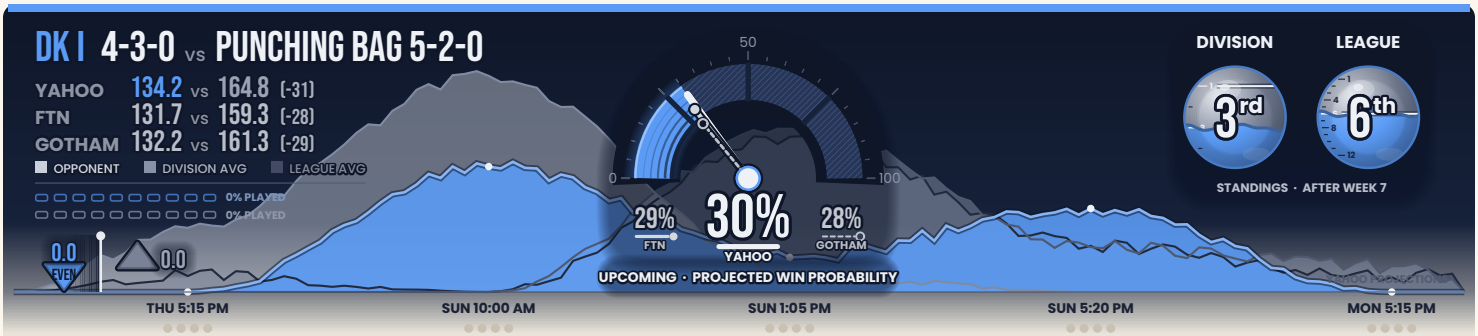
Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

OVERVIEW | CALLS | FIELD | POSITIONS

DK I 4-3-0 vs PUNCHING BAG 5-2-0

YAHOO	134.2	164.8	(-31)
FTN	131.7	159.3	(-28)
GOTHAM	132.2	161.3	(-29)

OPPONENT · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG



DIVISION 3rd · LEAGUE 6th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 7

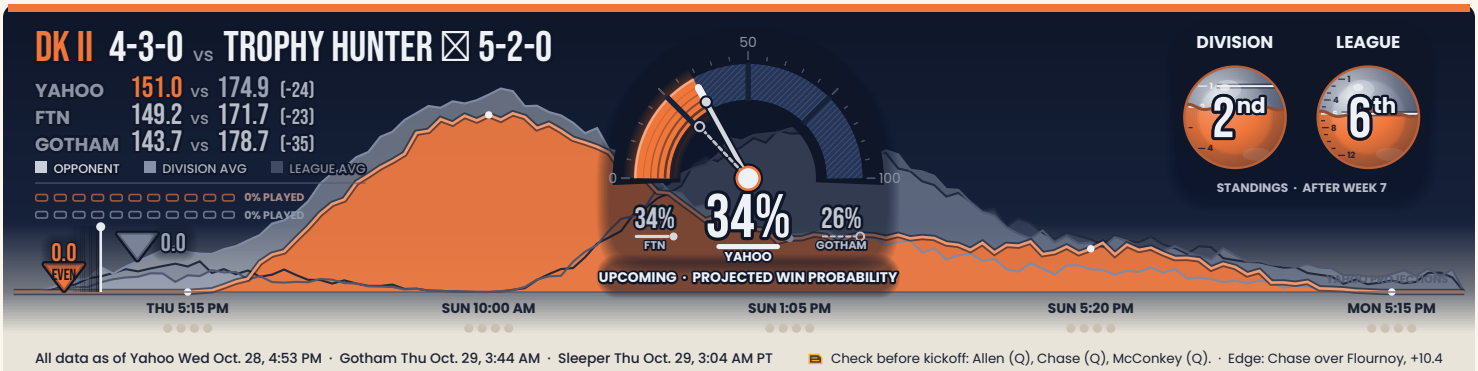
All data as of Yahoo Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM · Gotham Thu Oct. 29, 3:44 AM · Sleeper Thu Oct. 29, 3:04 AM PT

Check before kickoff: Pickens (Q), Diggs (Q). · Edge: Diggs over Concepcion, +1.3

DK II 4-3-0 vs TROPHY HUNTER ☒ 5-2-0

YAHOO	151.0	174.9	(-24)
FTN	149.2	171.7	(-23)
GOTHAM	143.7	178.7	(-35)

OPPONENT · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG



DIVISION 2nd · LEAGUE 6th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 7

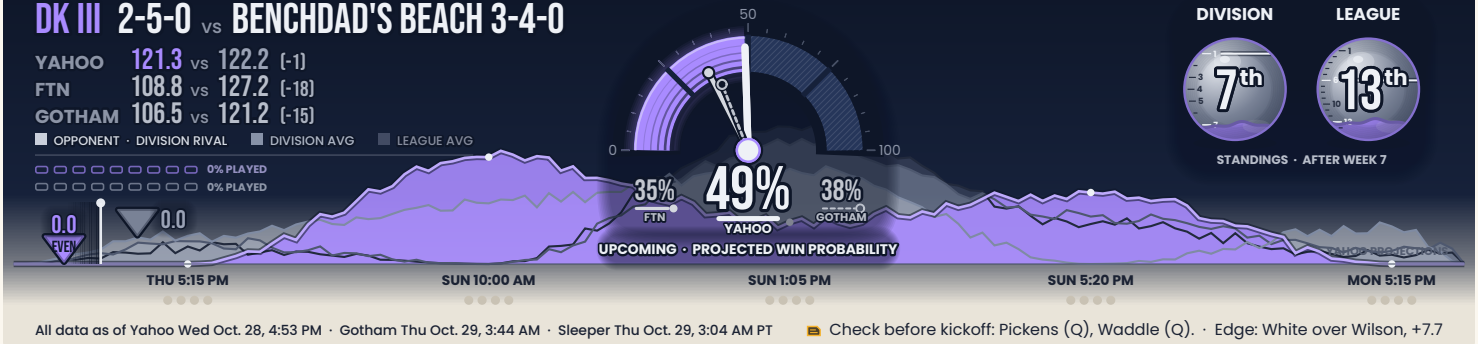
All data as of Yahoo Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM · Gotham Thu Oct. 29, 3:44 AM · Sleeper Thu Oct. 29, 3:04 AM PT

Check before kickoff: Allen (Q), Chase (Q), McConkey (Q). · Edge: Chase over Flournoy, +10.4

DK III 2-5-0 vs BENCHDAD'S BEACH 3-4-0

YAHOO	121.3	122.2	(-1)
FTN	108.8	127.2	(-18)
GOTHAM	106.5	121.2	(-15)

OPPONENT · DIVISION RIVAL · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG



DIVISION 7th · LEAGUE 13th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 7

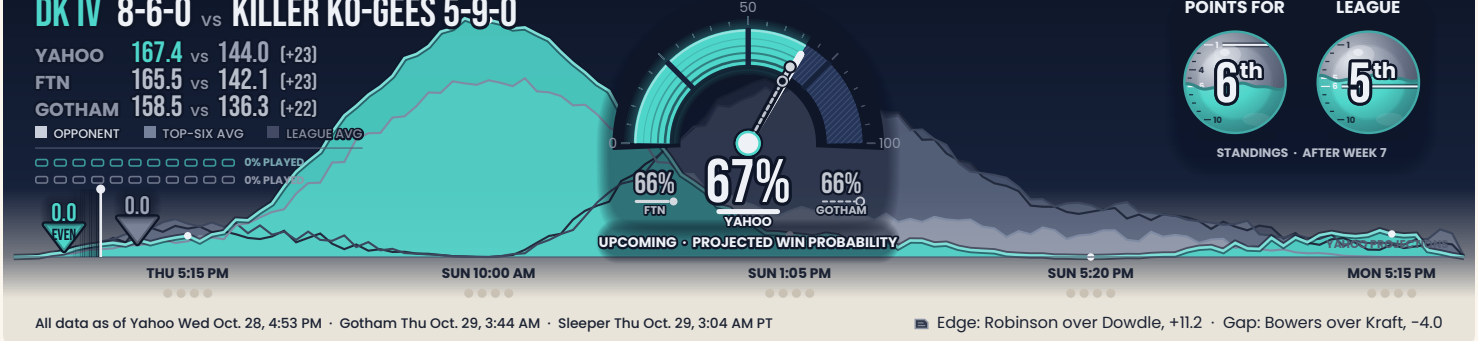
All data as of Yahoo Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM · Gotham Thu Oct. 29, 3:44 AM · Sleeper Thu Oct. 29, 3:04 AM PT

Check before kickoff: Pickens (Q), Waddle (Q). · Edge: White over Wilson, +7.7

DK IV 8-6-0 vs KILLER KO-GEES 5-9-0

YAHOO	167.4	144.0	(+23)
FTN	165.5	142.1	(+23)
GOTHAM	158.5	136.3	(+22)

OPPONENT · TOP-SIX AVG · LEAGUE AVG



POINTS FOR 6th · LEAGUE 5th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 7

All data as of Yahoo Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM · Gotham Thu Oct. 29, 3:44 AM · Sleeper Thu Oct. 29, 3:04 AM PT

Edge: Robinson over Dowdle, +11.2 · Gap: Bowers over Kraft, -4.0

WEEK 8, built Thu Oct 29 2026 03:44 AM PT. YAHOO: each lineup as set on Yahoo's matchup pages (pulled Wed Oct 28 04:53 PM PT); final games at actual, the rest as projected. GOTHAM: our engine (usage x rate x status, 2025 prior; run Thu Oct 29 03:44 AM PT). SLEEPER: Sleeper's public projections priced in each league's scoring, from the GitHub job (Thu Oct 29 03:04 AM PT). Kickers and defenses: Sleeper's number in both Gotham and Sleeper (no source beats a flat average there). METER: center = Yahoo's own posted win chance; left Gotham, right Sleeper, same spread math; gold ticks = share played. MOUNTAIN: Yahoo by kickoff window, Pacific; league and division layers from every team's matchup page (Wed Oct 28 04:53 PM PT). Every source checked: none missing, stale or short.

ACTION ITEMS · WEEK 8

What needs you, most urgent first · the full case is on each league's page · every move is your call

DK I	George Pickens is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): Pickens (shoulder/hamstring) was limited at W…	before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff
DK I	Stefon Diggs is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): Diggs (hand/hamstring/rest) was a non-participa…	before his Sun 5:20 PM kickoff
DK II	Braelon Allen is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): Jets head coach Aaron Glenn said that Allen will…	before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff
DK II	Ja'Marr Chase is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): Chase was listed as a non-participant in Wedne…	before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff
DK II	Ladd McConkey is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): McConkey (concussion) was a full participant in…	before his Sun 1:05 PM kickoff
DK III	George Pickens is questionable - latest (ESPN, Oct 28): Pickens (shoulder/hamstring) was limited at W…	before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff

+ 1 more, all in the morning brief

THE ADVICE, GRADED: Scout head-to-head calls graded: 119, the pick outscored the man he would replace 24 times (20%). Lineup alarms: 17 graded, 17 fixed in time. Open calls waiting on games

Gotham closest. Gotham ahead by 0.1 points a man.

Running total, Weeks 2–7, 723 men. Every number is the one posted before kickoff, graded against the final stat line in that league's scoring.

THIS WEEK · WEEK 7

14 of 14 games final · grows every build until Monday night · one week is noise

YAHOO	GOTHAM	SLEEPER
Week 7	Week 7	Week 7
6.1 points off a man	5.9 points off a man	6.0 points off a man
82 men graded	82 men graded	82 men graded
70% start/sit calls right	69% start/sit calls right	68% start/sit calls right

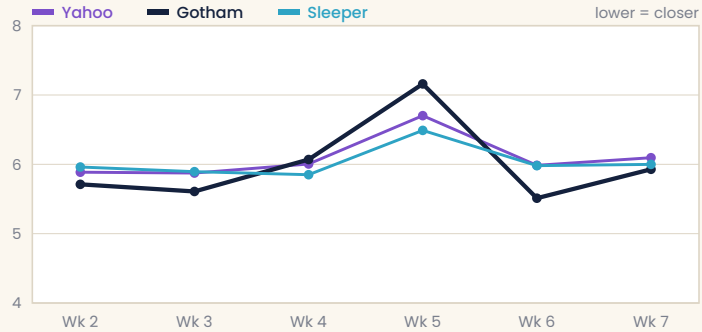
RUNNING TOTAL · WEEKS 2-7

The real signal · Weeks 2–4 graded by hand Oct 8, Week 5 on automatic

YAHOO	GOTHAM	SLEEPER
Weeks 2–7	Weeks 2–7	Weeks 2–7
6.0 points off a man	5.9 points off a man	6.0 points off a man
723 men graded	723 men graded	723 men graded
67% start/sit calls right	66% start/sit calls right	67% start/sit calls right

THE TREND · BY POSITION

Average points off a man, week by week · and where each source misses most



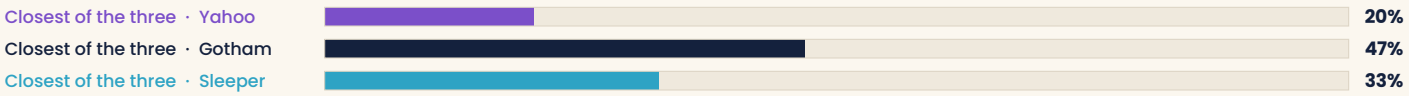
POS		Yahoo		Gotham		Sleeper	
QB	125	7.3	59%	7.2	58%	7.3	58%
RB	214	6.0	74%	5.9	74%	6.0	74%
WR	280	5.6	65%	5.4	64%	5.5	65%
TE	104	5.7	63%	5.5	63%	5.8	60%

Points off a man, then start/sit calls right. Green = closest at that position.

WHEN THEY DISAGREE

The three split by 4 points or more · the red box on the Field Report · the hard calls

49 men split 4+ points. Misses run bigger on them: Yahoo 7.8 points off, against 5.9 when the three agree.



BIGGEST MISSES · WEEK 7

Where all three were furthest off · green = the closest of the three on that man

PLAYER	LEAGUE	YAHOO	GOTHAM	SLEEPER	ACTUAL	WHAT HAPPENED
Tony Pollard, RB	DK II	16.2	12.2	15.5	42.8	Beat every number by 26.5
DeVonta Smith, WR	DK IV	15.8	13.6	15.8	0.0	Under every number by 13.6

Gotham's rule since Oct 11: a game a man left hurt (under 35% of snaps when he usually plays 60% or more) no longer counts against his number.
Oct 13 test (Weeks 2-5, 505 player-weeks): three changes kept, Gotham 6.61 to 6.35 pts a man; practice trim off; middle-starter nudge did not help.

SCORECARD

UPCOMING

UNDERDOG 134.2 to 164.8

Punching Bag · 5–2, 2nd of 12

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

DK I	134.2
Opp	164.8

Projected margin -30.6 · Yahoo, lineups as set

FTN	YAHOO	GOTHAM
29%	30%	28%

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

Players	Tagged: Pickens (Q), Diggs (Q)
Record	4–3 entering Week 8
Standing	6th of 12 entering the week · 5th in points

1 2 3 4 5 **6** 7 8 9 10 11 12

Playoff spots | Playoff line

OUTLOOK

WEEK 8

DK I goes in as the underdog. Yahoo projects 134.2 to 164.8 against Punching Bag (5–2, 2nd of 12), a 30.6-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 30%, FTN 29%, Gotham 28%. The three engines agree. At 4–3, 6th of 12: on the playoff line, with no room to give back.

Before kickoff. Pickens is Q; Diggs is Q. The best lineup closes about 0.0 of the 30.6-point gap, so the rest has to come from the starters beating their projections - check the Scout for an add that lifts this week.

Where it's won and lost. Theirs: J. Jacobs over Henderson at RB (-11.5); T. McBride over Kelce at TE (-8.3).

Week 8, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 8

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF								
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	OPPONENT	SCORE	DELTA
Jayden Daniels	↑	QB	WAS	QB	vs PHI	7	23.8	21.9	22.1	—	22.0	25.5	D. Presco…	27.2	
Jaylen Warren	4 Q20	RB	PIT	RB	vs CLE	9	18.7	18.5	18.4	—	19.6	20.7	D. Henry	20.6	
TreVeyon Henderson	1 Q11 ↓	RB	NE	RB	@ MIA	11	8.3	8.7	8.8	—	9.7	7.8	J. Jacobs	19.8	
George Pickens INJ Q	5	WR	DAL	WR	vs ARI	14	16.0	13.8	15.3	—	14.7	13.9	C. Watson	15.5	
Drake London	1 ↑	WR	ATL	WR	@ TB	11	16.6	15.8	13.7	—	15.1	15.5	A. St. Bro…	18.9	
Travis Kelce	1 Q20 ↑	TE	KC	TE	@ DEN	5	10.7	10.8	9.7	—	11.0	11.7	T. McBride	19.1	
Stefon Diggs INJ Q	2	WR	WAS	FLEX	vs PHI	7	12.4	11.8	12.2	—	13.2	13.9	K. Conce…	11.1	
Brenton Strange	1 ↑	TE	JAX	FLEX	vs IND	7	10.3	9.1	10.5	—	9.8	10.0	J. Mason	15.1	
Will Reichard	Q07	K	MIN	K	@ DET	6	7.6	11.7	—	—	—	—	C. Boswell	7.2	
Commanders	Q15	DEF	WAS	DEF	vs PHI	7	9.8	9.6	—	—	—	—	NE D	10.3	
TOTAL							**134.2**							164.8	

BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF						
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Tyler Shough	2	QB	NO	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	21.7	22.6	On bye · back Wk 9
Christian McCaffrey INJ Q	5	RB	SF	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	24.3	23.6	On bye · back Wk 9
Chris Godwin Jr.	1 D ↑	WR	TB	BN	vs ATL	10	—	9.1	10.8	—	10.7	7.7	Covers London's Wk 11 bye
Kaelon Black	2 ↑	RB	SF	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	7.1	6.4	On bye · back Wk 9
Vikings	Q15	WR		BN	BYE	1	—	—	—	—	—	—	On bye · back Wk 9

IR

1 of 1 slot used

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF						
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Travis Etienne Jr. INJ IR	1 ↓	RB	NO	IR	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	13.6	12.8	On IR · holds no roster seat

F	game final, SCORE is real. No F: still a projection.
INJ	Yahoo's tag: Q questionable, D doubtful, O out, IR.
Score	green = beat Yahoo's projection by 3+; red = 4+ short.
Projected	each source before kickoff; Gotham skips K and DEF.

Band	around a whole row: he is playing right now.
Markers	2 Radar news (count) · Q03 Scout need (days)
	D role drift · ↑ playing time up / down
	Red = act, gold = watch, green = good. Up to four per man, news first.

The Scout is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

If George Pickens Sits — Questionable, starting at WR2 (~13.8 this week). The best lineup without him is ~4.6 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call). **Best fills, points added this week and next: Makai Lemon**, PHI WR +1 now, +0 next week (Waivers, Clears Oct 30).

If Stefon Diggs Sits — Questionable, starting at FLEX1 (~11.8 this week). The bench covers it: the best lineup without him is only ~2.7 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call).

Expert Moves (read Thu Oct 29 2026 3:44 AM PT) no big moves on your roster

Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

The Defense Won't Hold — DEF, Season-Long · Target 11.7 pts 15

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~17.3 (Vikings). Wk 8 Commanders ~9.6 (Vikings has a worse matchup) · Wk 9 Vikings ~9.1 (hard matchup vs BUF) · Wk 10 Vikings ~12.6 · Wk 11 Vikings ~9.9 (hard matchup vs SF) · Wk 12 Vikings ~13.7 · Wk 13 Vikings ~13.0 · Wk 14 Vikings ~13.8 · Wk 15 Vikings ~9.1 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 16 Vikings ~12.2 (hard matchup vs WAS) · Wk 17 Vikings ~14.4.

▶ **KC DEF** · Scored 19, -1, 17, 6, 26, 6 · Waivers, Clears Oct 31 · Current level ~12.3 a game; rival check: 10 teams would start him over one of their own - JD ($89 left, waiver #9), DIKFORE ($49 left, waiver #7), Rolling With Romo ($75 left, waiver #6), World Of Pain ($54 left, waiver #5), Punching Bag ($66 left, waiver #4), Raider nation ($90 left, waiver #3); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 10.3, engine 9.4 a week); helps Wk 9. · **Adds ~6 pts through Wk 17** (2 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your DEF Commanders DEF: Ratcliffe 10.3 vs 9.6 · Yahoo 8.5 vs 9.8 - mixed - Ratcliffe says better**

JAX DEF · Scored 20, 6, 23, 11, 7, -1 · Waivers, Clears Oct 31 · Current level ~9.1 a game; rival check: 5 teams would start him over one of their own - JD ($89 left, waiver #9), DIKFORE ($49 left, waiver #7), World Of Pain ($54 left, waiver #5), Punching Bag ($66 left, waiver #4), Remember the Tutens ($56 left, waiver #10); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 11.5, engine 10.7 a week); helps Wk 8. · **Adds ~2 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your DEF Commanders DEF: Ratcliffe 11.5 vs 9.6 · Yahoo 10.2 vs 9.8 - better this week**

The Kicker Spot Won't Hold — K, Season-Long · Target 9.1 pts 07

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~11.7 (Reichard). Wk 9 Reichard ~9.6 · Wk 10 Reichard ~8.4 (hard matchup vs GB) · Wk 12 Reichard ~9.4 (hard matchup vs ATL) · Wk 14 Reichard ~9.6 · Wk 15 Reichard ~8.6 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 17 Reichard ~9.2 (hard matchup vs NYJ).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

The Tight End Spot Runs Thin — TE, Weeks 8-10 Fill · Target 9.9 pts 20

Drops Off After Wk 10

Full strength ~10.5 (Strange). Wk 8 Kelce ~10.8 (Strange has a worse matchup) · Wk 9 Kelce ~8.5 (Strange has a worse matchup) · Wk 10 Kelce ~10.4 (Strange has a worse matchup).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

Also on the Board RB2, Weeks 8-9 Fill | WR2, Weeks 11, 14 Fill | FLEX1, Week 11 Fill | RB1, Week 8 Fill | QB, Week 13 Fill

Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

▶ **FLEX1, Weeks 9, 13-15, 17 · Pierre Strong**, GB RB · Scored 6.0, 14.4 · Free Agent · Door open: Chris Brooks out; getting 14.9 expected but scoring 10.2; news (RotoBaller, Oct 16): Pierre Strong Jr. Has Minimal Flex Appeal In Week 6; CHECK FIRST: plays Thursday night (5:15 PM PT) - if you start him and he sits, your Sunday players have already locked; his work depends on Chris Brooks staying out - check Brooks's status first; ENGINE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 2.7 a week vs engine 14.8); helps Wk 9, Wks 13-15, Wk 17. · **Adds ~12 pts through Wk 17** (5 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your RB2 TreVeyon Henderson: Ratcliffe 2.7 vs 8.7 · Yahoo not read vs 8.3 · Gotham not read vs 8.8 - WORSE this week** Watch: Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up.

Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

Checked, Not Assumed Watch: Pierre Strong (GB RB) - Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up. · Stash: Seth McGowan (IND RB, free agent) - 25% of the IND backfield's touches the last three games behind Jonathan Taylor (~25.0 a game, 75%); the lead job is his if Taylor goes down; his own level now ~4.6 · Stash: Samaje Perine (CIN RB, free agent) - 36% of the CIN backfield's touches the last three games behind Chase Brown (~17.0 a game, 59%); the lead job is his if Brown goes down; his own level now ~6.9 · Rising: Davis Allen (LA TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 12.7 expected points last game from 2.6 before; season level ~2.8, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Jacob Cowing (SF WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 9.5 expected points last game from 1.5 before; season level ~1.4, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Your starter fading: Jaylen Warren (PIT RB) snaps 90% to 75% (typical game), touch share 80% to 69% the last three games; Rico Dowdle (rostered) is taking the work - snaps 9% to 24%, touch share 12% to 30%, level now ~12.9 · Early warning: Omarion Hampton (LAC RB) snaps 58% to 35% (typical game), touch share 68% to 39% the last three games; Kimani Vidal (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 14% to 38%, touch share 5% to 31%, level now ~10.2 · Early warning: Jonathan Taylor (IND RB) snaps 85% to 73% (typical game), touch share 85% to 75% the last three games; Seth McGowan (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 17% to 28%, touch share 15% to 25%, level now ~4.6 · Colby Parkinson (LA TE) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.9 a game; ranks below the picks above · George Holani (SEA RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Jadarian Price Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · Mason Taylor (NYJ TE) is on the Positions chart (workload 4.2->8.0): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.5 a game; ranks below the picks above

Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce, Kaelon Black · Rosters Yahoo Wed Oct 28, 4:56 PM PT · Stats nflverse Thu 3:44 AM PT

DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

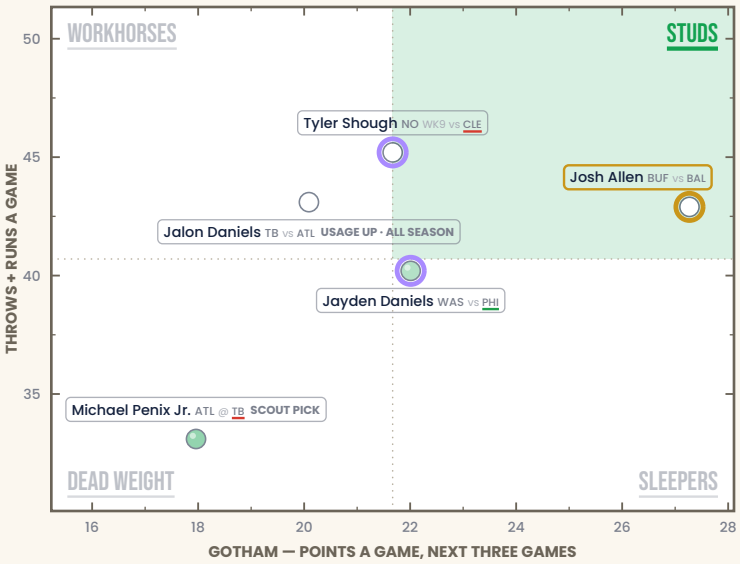
POSITIONS • DK I

Week 8 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

QUARTERBACKS

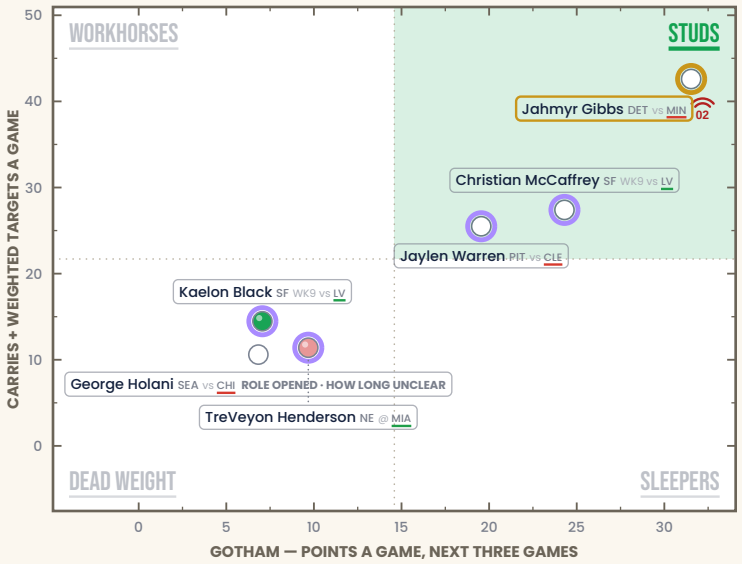
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 18.7 a game — 85% of Jayden Daniels, the weakest starter here (22.0).
Doors: Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2; Michael Penix Jr. — Scout pick — adds ~5 pts through Wk 17

RUNNING BACKS

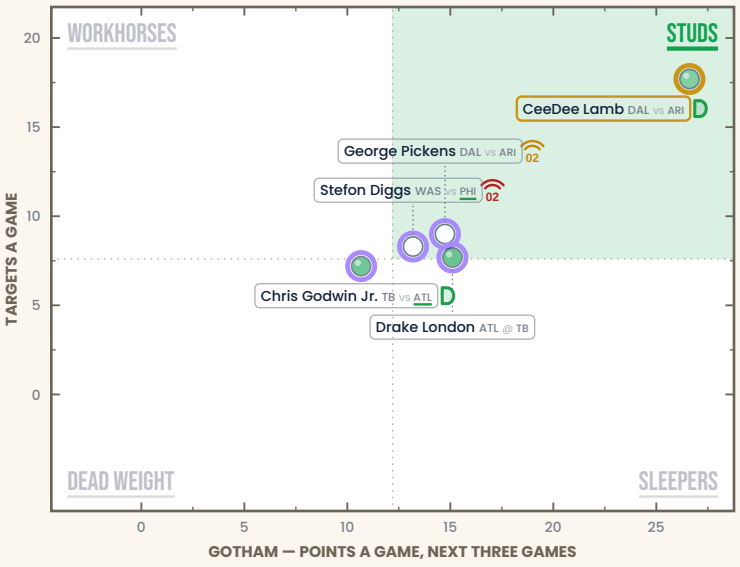
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 8.2 a game — 85% of TreVeyon Henderson, the weakest starter here (9.7).
Doors: George Holani — teammate down this week: Jadarian Price Out

RECEIVERS

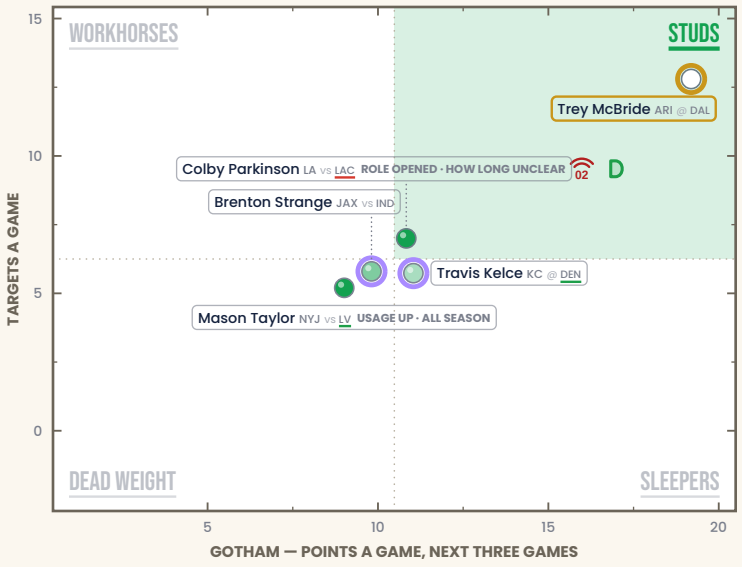
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 11.2 a game — 85% of Stefon Diggs, the weakest starter here (13.2).
Doors: no free agent clears the floor through any door. Closest: Kendrick Bourne ARI 9.4, Malik Washington MIA 9.4.

TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 8.3 a game — 85% of Brenton Strange, the weakest starter here (9.8).
Doors: Colby Parkinson — teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out; Mason Taylor — workload 4.2->8.0

Legend: rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat · violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster
Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page
vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.
Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham
Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · on the Call Sheet

How to read it: Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

SCORECARD

UPCOMING

UNDERDOG 151.0 to 174.9

Trophy Hunter · 5–2, 3rd of 12

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

DK II	151.0
Opp	174.9

Projected margin -23.9 · Yahoo, lineups as set



34% FTN · 34% YAHOO · 26% GOTHAM

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

Players	Tagged: Allen (Q), Chase (Q), McConkey (Q)
Record	4–3 entering Week 8
Standing	6th of 12 entering the week · 10th in points

1 2 3 4 5 **6** 7 8 9 10 11 12

Playoff spots | Playoff line

OUTLOOK

WEEK 8

DK II goes in as the underdog. Yahoo projects 151.0 to 174.9 against Trophy Hunter (5–2, 3rd of 12), a 23.9-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 34%, FTN 34%, Gotham 26%. The three engines agree. At 4–3, 6th of 12: on the playoff line, with no room to give back.

Before kickoff. Allen is Q; Chase is Q; McConkey is Q. FTN would start Chiefs over Browns (+1.3). The best lineup closes about 1.3 of the 23.9-point gap, so the rest has to come from the starters beating their projections - check the Scout for an add that lifts this week.

Where it's won and lost. Your edges: Chase over R. Flournoy at WR (+10.4); London over S. Diggs at WR (+4.2). Theirs: J. Williams over Mitchell at RB (-14.3); T. McBride over Kelce at TE (-8.4). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on McConkey (7.6 vs 11.3) and London (13.7 vs 16.7) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 8, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 8

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	OPPONENT	SCORE	DELTA
Jacoby Brissett	🔔 Q09 ↑	QB	ARI	QB	@ DAL	14	23.2	19.9	21.5	—	21.1	19.2	J. Allen	29.3	
Braelon Allen INJ Q	🔔 Q18 ↑	RB	NYJ	RB	vs LV	13	11.9	11.4	12.1	—	12.9	14.2	J. Warren	18.8	
Keaton Mitchell	🔔 Q01 ↓	RB	LAC	RB	@ LA	7	7.5	5.8	6.8	—	7.2	7.6	J. Williams	21.8	
Drake London	↑	WR	ATL	WR	@ TB	11	16.7	15.8	13.7	—	15.1	15.5	S. Diggs	12.5	
Germie Bernard		WR	PIT	WR	vs CLE	9	10.8	10.9	10.5	—	12.0	9.8	K. Shakir	9.9	
Ja'Marr Chase INJ Q	🔔	WR	CIN	WR	vs TEN	6	20.2	20.1	18.9	—	17.5	16.2	R. Flourn…	9.9	
Travis Kelce	Q20 ↑	TE	KC	TE	@ DEN	5	10.8	10.8	9.7	—	11.0	11.7	T. McBride	19.1	
Ladd McConkey INJ Q	🔔 Q01 ↓	WR	LAC	FLEX	@ LA	7	11.3	10.8	7.6	—	8.0	7.8	O. Gordo…	16.1	
Jayden Daniels	↑	QB	WAS	SFLEX	vs PHI	7	23.8	21.9	22.1	—	22.0	25.5	J. Love	22.0	
Will Reichard	Q07	K	MIN	K	@ DET	6	8.5	13.2	—	—	—	—	H. Butker	7.8	
Browns		DEF	CLE	DEF	@ PIT	11	6.2	7.3	—	—	—	—	NE D	7.6	
TOTAL							151.0							174.9	

BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Alvin Kamara	🔔 ↑	RB	NO	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	12.5	12.7	On bye · back Wk 9
Aaron Rodgers		QB	PIT	BN	vs CLE	9	—	18.1	19.4	—	19.9	20.2	Superflex depth at QB
Kyle Pitts Sr.	↑	TE	ATL	BN	@ TB	11	—	9.9	7.8	—	9.0	9.0	Depth at TE · 9.0 next 3
David Montgomery INJ Q	🔔 ↓	RB	HOU	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	11.7	11.7	On bye · back Wk 9
Chiefs		WR		BN	BYE	1	—	—	—	—	—	—	On bye · back Wk 9

IR

1 of 2 slots used

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Travis Etienne Jr. INJ IR	Q01 ↓	RB	NO	IR	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	13.6	12.8	On IR · holds no roster seat
OPEN				IR									Open IR slot

F final **INJ** Yahoo tag **Score** green beat Yahoo by 3+, red 4+ short **Band** playing now **Markers** 🔔 alert news Q03 Scout need **D** drift ↑ playing time

The Scout is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

Open Seats — 1 IR slot open (only for a player Yahoo lists as IR or Out)

If Braelon Allen Sits — Questionable, starting at RB1 (~11.4 this week). The best lineup without him is ~11.4 pts lower. If Yahoo lists him Out, the open IR slot can hold him and the add costs no drop. **Best fills, points added this week and next: Samaje Perine**, CIN RB +9 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Kenny Gainwell**, TB RB +8 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Chris Rodriguez Jr.**, JAX RB +8 now, +0 next week (free agent).

If Ja'Marr Chase Sits — Questionable, starting at WR1 (~20.1 this week). The best lineup without him is ~10.2 pts lower. If Yahoo lists him Out, the open IR slot can hold him and the add costs no drop.

If Ladd McConkey Sits — Questionable, starting at FLEX (~10.8 this week). The bench covers it: the best lineup without him is only ~0.9 pts lower. If Yahoo lists him Out, the open IR slot can hold him and the add costs no drop.

Missing Pieces **A lead running back** - Braelon Allen drops to about 9 a game once Breece Hall is back; Etienne (IR, earliest Week 9) and Montgomery are the hope, neither confirmed · **A wide receiver for Week 10 on** - Germie Bernard's role shrinks when Michael Pittman returns; McConkey (claimed Oct 25) is the bet if he clears his concussion

Expert Moves (read Thu Oct 29 2026 3:44 AM PT) no big moves on your roster

Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

Also on the Board RB1, Season-Long | K, Season-Long | RB2, Weeks 8-9, 12, 14 Fill | FLEX, Weeks 8, 14 Fill | SUPERFLEX, Weeks 9, 12, 16 Fill | TE, Weeks 8, 12, 14 Fill | WR2, Week 11 Fill | DEF, Week 12 Fill

Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

- **RB1, Weeks 9, 13-15, 17** · **Pierre Strong**, GB RB · Scored 6.0, 14.4 · Free Agent · Door open: Chris Brooks out; getting 14.9 expected but scoring 10.2; news (RotoBaller, Oct 16): Pierre Strong Jr. Has Minimal Flex Appeal In Week 6; CHECK FIRST: plays Thursday night (5:15 PM PT) - if you start him and he sits, your Sunday players have already locked; his work depends on Chris Brooks staying out - check Brooks's status first; ENGINE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 2.7 a week vs engine 14.8); helps Wk 9, Wks 13-15, Wk 17. · **Adds ~13 pts through Wk 17** (6 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your RB2 Keaton Mitchell: Ratcliffe 2.7 vs 5.8 · Yahoo not read vs 7.5 · Gotham not read vs 6.8 - WORSE this week** · **Fills a missing piece** Watch: Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up.
- **SUPERFLEX, Weeks 9, 16** · **J.J. McCarthy**, NYG QB · Scored 0.7, 18.8, 10.4 · Free Agent · Door open: Jaxson Dart out; workload up from 1.6 to 12.2 expected a game; NEWS FLAG - check before acting: (RotoBaller, Oct 27): J.J. McCarthy Worth a Speculative Waiver Addition; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Jaxson Dart staying out - check Dart's status first; BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 13.6, engine 13.8 a week); helps Wk 9, Wk 16. · **Adds ~2 pts through Wk 17** (2 in the playoffs) · **This week: J.J. McCarthy has a bye - no help this week**
- **SUPERFLEX, Week 9** · **Justin Herbert**, LAC QB · Scored 16.5, 10.6, 15.7, 13.1, 13.7, 10.0 · Free Agent · Getting 19.5 expected but scoring 13.3; news (RotoBaller, Oct 21): Chargers Considering Simplifying Offense for Justin Herbert; ENGINE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 15.4 a week vs engine 18.3); helps Wk 9. · **Adds ~1 pts through Wk 17** (0 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your SUPERFLEX Jacoby Brissett: Ratcliffe 16.1 vs 19.9 · Yahoo 18.1 vs 23.2 · Gotham 17.2 vs 21.5 - WORSE this week**

Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

Checked, Not Assumed Allen ~19.6 to ~7.9 from Wk 8 — Breece Hall checked: rostered by Hector Football · Watch: Pierre Strong (GB RB) - Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up. · Stash: Kaelon Black (SF RB, free agent) - 35% of the SF backfield's touches the last three games behind Christian McCaffrey (~25.1 a game, 63%); the lead job is his if McCaffrey goes down; his own level now ~8.2 · Stash: Roschon Johnson (CHI RB, free agent) - 32% of the CHI backfield's touches the last three games behind D'Andre Swift (~21.7 a game, 68%); the lead job is his if Swift goes down; his own level now ~7.2 · Rising: Davis Allen (LA TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 12.7 expected points last game from 2.6 before; season level ~2.8, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Jacob Cowing (SF WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 9.5 expected points last game from 1.5 before; season level ~1.4, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Early warning: Omarion Hampton (LAC RB) snaps 58% to 35% (typical game), touch share 68% to 39% the last three games; Kimani Vidal (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 14% to 38%, touch share 5% to 31%, level now ~10.2 · Early warning: Jonathan Taylor (IND RB) snaps 85% to 73% (typical game), touch share 85% to 75% the last three games; Seth McGowan (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 17% to 28%, touch share 15% to 25%, level now ~4.6 · Brian Thomas Jr. (JAX WR) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk9 Germie Bernard): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~5.3 a game; ranks below the picks above · Chris Bell (MIA WR) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk9 Germie Bernard): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~3.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · Colby Parkinson (LA TE) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.9 a game; ranks below the picks above · George Holani (SEA RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Jadarian Price Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.7 a game; ranks below the picks above

Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce · Rosters Yahoo Wed Oct 28, 4:56 PM PT · Stats nflverse Thu 3:44 AM PT

DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

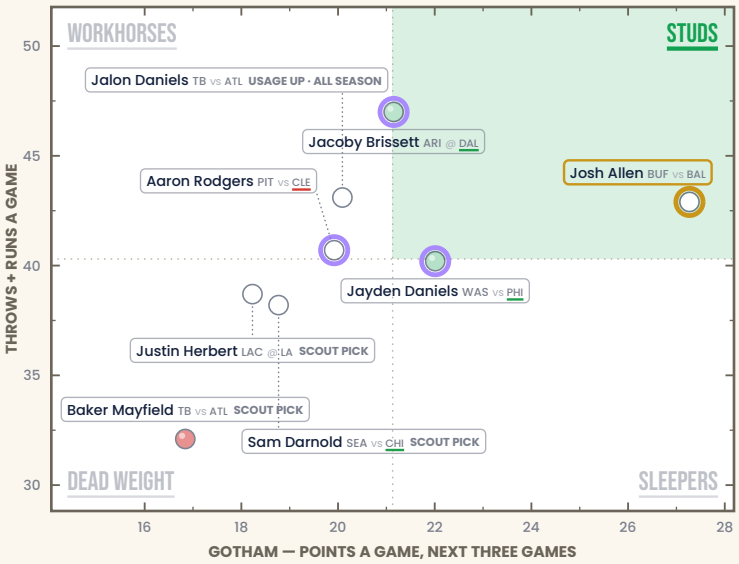
POSITIONS • DK II

Week 8 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

QUARTERBACKS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**

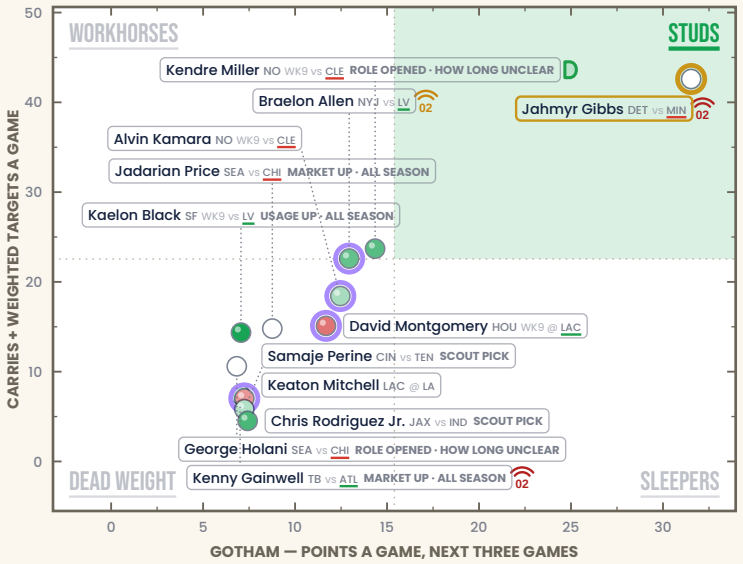


Floor: 18.0 a game — 85% of Jacoby Brissett, the weakest starter here (21.1).

Doors: Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2; Sam Darnold — Scout pick — adds ~6 pts through Wk 17; Baker Mayfield — Scout pick — adds ~3 pts through Wk 17; Justin Herbert — Scout pick — adds ~1 pts through Wk 17

RUNNING BACKS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**

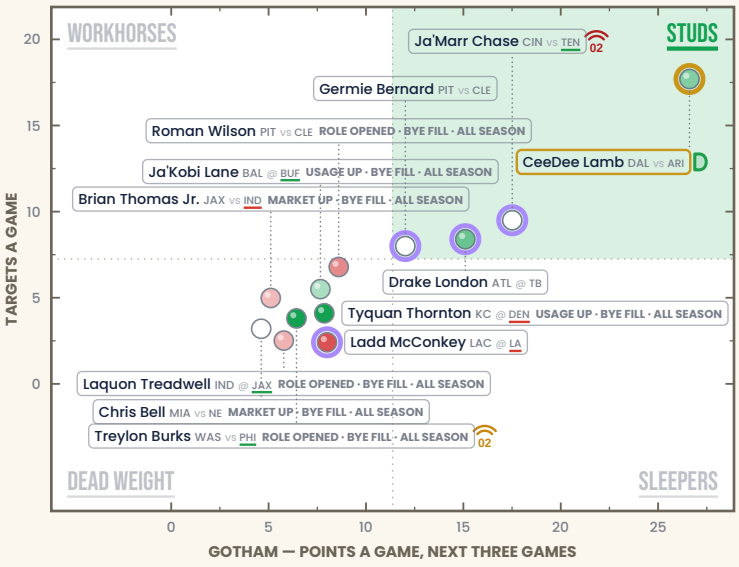


Floor: 6.2 a game — 85% of Keaton Mitchell, the weakest starter here (7.2).

Doors: Kenny Gainwell — ; Kendre Miller — teammate out: Travis Etienne; Jadarian Price — ; Kaelon Black — workload 10.0->20.7

RECEIVERS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



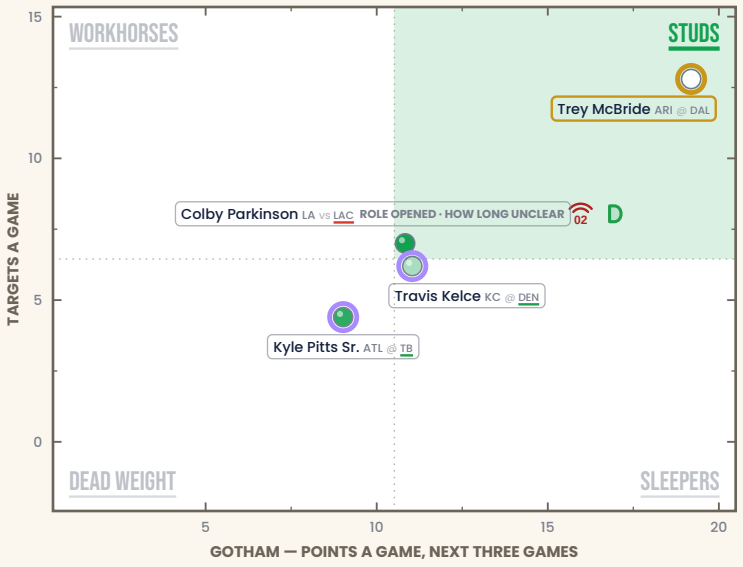
Floor: 6.8 a game — 85% of Ladd McConkey, the weakest starter here (8.0).

Doors: Roman Wilson — teammate out: Michael Pittman Jr.; covers Wk11 Drake London; Tyquan Thornton — workload 2.3->9.4; covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk9 Germie Bernard; Ja'Kobi Lane — workload 5.0->6.4; covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk9 Germie Bernard; Treylon Burks…

Check: Sleeper far lower than Gotham — Brian Thomas Jr. 5.1 vs 8.7. Look before acting.

TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 9.4 a game — 85% of Travis Kelce, the weakest starter here (11.0).

Doors: Colby Parkinson — teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out

Legend: rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat · violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster

Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page

vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.

Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham

Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · 03 news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · 1 on the Call Sheet

How to read it: Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

SCORECARD

UPCOMING

TOSS-UP 121.3 to 122.2

Benchdad's Beach · 3–4, 6th of 14

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

DK III	121.3
Opp	122.2

Projected margin -0.9 · Yahoo, lineups as set



Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

Players	Tagged: Pickens (Q), Waddle (Q)
Record	2–5 entering Week 8
Standing	13th of 14 entering the week · 13th in points

1 2 3 4 5 6 | 7 8 9 10 11 12 **13** 14

Playoff spots | Playoff line

OUTLOOK

WEEK 8

DK III goes in in a toss-up. Yahoo projects 121.3 to 122.2 against Benchdad's Beach (3–4, 6th of 14), a 0.9-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 49%, FTN 35%, Gotham 38%. The engines split by 14: Yahoo uses the lineups as set, FTN and Gotham the best ones. At 2–5, 13th of 14: 7 spots below the playoff line, so this week counts.

Before kickoff. Pickens is Q; Waddle is Q. Making those moves roughly closes the gap.

Where it's won and lost. Your edges: White over E. Wilson at RB (+7.7); Hockenson over T. Higbee at TE (+3.3). Theirs: K. Walker III over Coleman at RB (-13.6); O. Hampton over Downs at FLEX (-2.1). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on White (11.0 vs 15.6) and Fannin (6.8 vs 10.2) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 8, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 8

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF								
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	OPPONENT	SCORE	DELTA
Jayden Daniels	↑	QB	WAS	QB	vs PHI	7	23.8	21.9	22.1	—	22.0	25.5	J. Brissett	23.2	
Rachaad White	🔔 📡1 🔍01	RB	WAS	RB	vs PHI	7	15.6	11.9	11.0	—	10.9	11.6	E. Wilson	8.0	
Jonah Coleman	🔔 📡1 ↑	RB	DEN	RB	vs KC	10	11.4	11.4	11.9	—	15.4	9.5	K. Walker…	24.9	
George Pickens INJ Q	🔔 📡5	WR	DAL	WR	vs ARI	14	16.0	13.8	15.3	—	14.7	13.9	C. Watson	15.5	
Jaylen Waddle INJ Q	🔔 📡6	WR	DEN	WR	vs KC	10	11.7	10.0	9.8	—	10.4	9.2	L. Burden…	12.8	
T.J. Hockenson	📡1 ↑	TE	MIN	TE	@ DET	6	11.4	10.3	10.1	—	10.9	10.5	T. Higbee	8.1	
Josh Downs	📡5 ↓	WR	IND	FLEX	@ JAX	13	10.6	9.2	8.6	—	9.4	8.2	O. Hamp…	12.6	
Harold Fannin Jr.	📡3 ↑	TE	CLE	FLEX	@ PIT	11	10.2	9.4	6.8	—	10.1	9.5	C. Parkin…	6.9	
Steelers		DEF	PIT	DEF	vs CLE	9	10.8	10.9	—	—	—	—	JAX D	10.2	
TOTAL							**121.4**							122.2	

BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF						
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Aaron Rodgers	📡1	QB	PIT	BN	vs CLE	9	—	18.1	19.4	—	19.9	20.2	Depth at QB · 19.9 next 3
Devaughn Vele	🔔 📡2 ↓	WR	NO	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	11.1	12.3	On bye · back Wk 9
David Montgomery INJ Q	🔔 📡2 🔍01 ↓	RB	HOU	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	11.7	11.7	On bye · back Wk 9
Caleb Douglas	🔔 📡1 ↓	WR	MIA	BN	vs NE	6	—	9.0	5.8	—	9.1	13.1	Covers Waddle's Wk 10 bye
Packers	🔍20	WR		BN	BYE	1	—	—	—	—	—	—	On bye · back Wk 9

IR

1 of 1 slot used

							PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF						
PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Michael Pittman Jr. INJ IR	🔔 📡1	WR	PIT	IR	vs CLE	9	—	—	0.0	—	6.1	5.3	On IR · holds no roster seat

F game final, SCORE is real. No F: still a projection.
INJ Yahoo's tag: Q questionable, D doubtful, O out, IR.
Score green = beat Yahoo's projection by 3+; red = 4+ short.
Projected each source before kickoff; Gotham skips K and DEF.

Band around a whole row: he is playing right now.
Markers 📡2 Radar news (count) 🔍03 Scout need (days)
D role drift ↑ playing time up / down
Red = act, gold = watch, green = good. Up to four per man, news first.

The Scout is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

If George Pickens Sits — Questionable, starting at WR1 (~13.8 this week). The best lineup without him is ~4.7 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call). **Best fills, points added this week and next: Xavier Worthy**, KC WR +1 now, +0 next week (Waivers, Clears Oct 31).

If Jaylen Waddle Sits — Questionable, starting at WR2 (~10.0 this week). The bench covers it: the best lineup without him is only ~0.9 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call).

Missing Pieces **A lead running back - save the $91 for him** - Every back is a fill-in: Bam Knight until Love returns, White until Croskey-Merritt does, Perine in a split, Montgomery hurt
Expert Moves (read Thu Oct 29 2026 3:44 AM PT) no big moves on your roster

Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

The Backfield Won't Hold — RB1, Season-Long · Target 12.3 pts 01/3

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~10.9 (White). Wk 9 Montgomery ~13.2 (White moves up to FLEX2, Montgomery slides in) · Wk 10 Montgomery ~12.1 (White moves up to RB2, Montgomery slides in) · Wk 11 Montgomery ~12.7 (White has a worse matchup) · Wk 12 Montgomery ~11.8 (White moves up to RB2, Montgomery slides in) · Wk 13 Montgomery ~12.2 (White moves up to FLEX1, Montgomery slides in) · Wk 14 Montgomery ~11.9 (White moves up to FLEX1, Montgomery slides in).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

The Flex Runs Thin — FLEX2, Weeks 9-10 Fill · Target 9.1 pts 20

Drops Off After Wk 10

Full strength ~9.3 (Montgomery). Wk 9 White ~10.0 (Montgomery moves up to RB1, White slides in) · Wk 10 Douglas ~8.2 (Montgomery moves up to RB1, Douglas slides in).

▶ **Xavier Worthy**, KC WR · Scored 4.8, 13.5, 4.0, 11.0, 14.3, 4.1 · Waivers, Clears Oct 31 · Current level ~8.7 a game; news (ESPN, Oct 28): Xavier Worthy's Week 8 fantasy outlook; rival check: 3 teams would start him over one of their own - Benchdad's Beach ($60 left, waiver #9), Press Coverage steph ($100 left, waiver #5), Mrs. Bobo ($100 left, waiver #1); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 10.1, engine 9.4 a week); helps Wk 10. · **Adds ~7 pts through Wk 17** (0 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your FLEX2 Josh Downs: Ratcliffe 10.1 vs 9.2 · Yahoo 9.1 vs 10.6 · Gotham 8.7 vs 8.6 - mixed - Ratcliffe says better**

Also on the Board DEF, Weeks 9, 12, 14 Fill · WR1, Weeks 10, 13-14 Fill · TE, Weeks 10-11, 14 Fill · WR2, Weeks 10, 14 Fill · RB2, Week 10 Fill · FLEX1, Week 10 Fill

Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

▶ **RB2, Season-Long** · **Pierre Strong**, GB RB · Scored 6.0, 14.4 · Free Agent · Door open: Chris Brooks out; getting 14.9 expected but scoring 10.2; news (RotoBaller, Oct 16): Pierre Strong Jr. Has Minimal Flex Appeal In Week 6; CHECK FIRST: plays Thursday night (5:15 PM PT) - if you start him and he sits, your Sunday players have already locked; his work depends on Chris Brooks staying out - check Brooks's status first; ENGINE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 2.7 a week vs engine 14.8); helps Wks 9-10, Wks 12-17. · **Adds ~30 pts through Wk 17** (10 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your FLEX2 Josh Downs: Ratcliffe 2.7 vs 9.2 · Yahoo not read vs 10.6 · Gotham not read vs 8.6 - WORSE this week** · **Fills a missing piece** Watch: Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up.

▶ **QB, Weeks 13, 15** · **Michael Penix Jr.**, ATL QB · Scored 16.5, 15.2, 16.9, 29.4, 27.7 · Free Agent · Door open: Cooper Rush out; workload up from 14.6 to 21.0 expected a game; door closing: Andy Dalton joined ATL from PHI: his pre-trade ~20.2 a game cut to ~19.5 (3% of the QB production goes to the newcomer); news (PFT, Oct 28): Michael Penix Jr. wins first NFC offensive player of the week award; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Cooper Rush staying out - check Rush's status first; BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 18.7, engine 16.9 a week); helps Wk 13, Wk 15. · **Adds ~7 pts through Wk 17** (2 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your QB Jayden Daniels: Ratcliffe 18.0 vs 21.9 · Yahoo 17.7 vs 23.8 · Gotham 17.4 vs 22.1 - WORSE this week**

Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

Checked, Not Assumed Can't claim: Samaje Perine (CIN RB) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Oct 31 and you can add him then. · Can't claim: Bam Knight (ARI RB) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Oct 31 and you can add him then. · Watch: Pierre Strong (GB RB) - Yahoo/Sleeper have him at 0.8 at best - the Scout's ~13.1 isn't backed up. · Stash: Seth McGowan (IND RB, free agent) - 25% of the IND backfield's touches the last three games behind Jonathan Taylor (~25.0 a game, 75%); the lead job is his if Taylor goes down; his own level now ~4.6 · Stash: Samaje Perine (CIN RB, waivers, clears Oct 31) - 36% of the CIN backfield's touches the last three games behind Chase Brown (~17.0 a game, 59%); the lead job is his if Brown goes down; his own level now ~6.9 · Rising: Davis Allen (LA TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 12.7 expected points last game from 2.6 before; season level ~2.8, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Jacob Cowing (SF WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 9.5 expected points last game from 1.5 before; season level ~1.4, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Early warning: Omarion Hampton (LAC RB) snaps 58% to 35% (typical game), touch share 68% to 39% the last three games; Kimani Vidal (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 14% to 38%, touch share 5% to 31%, level now ~10.2 · Early warning: Jonathan Taylor (IND RB) snaps 85% to 73% (typical game), touch share 85% to 75% the last three games; Seth McGowan (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 17% to 28%, touch share 15% to 25%, level now ~4.6 · Cade Otton (TB TE) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~5.2 a game; ranks below the picks above · Charlie Kolar (LAC TE) is on the Positions chart (workload 2.3->7.4; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~5.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · Darnell Washington (PIT TE) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~6.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · David Njoku (LAC TE) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~6.6 a game; ranks below the picks above
Protected: none · Rosters Yahoo Wed Oct 28, 4:56 PM PT · Stats nflverse Thu 3:44 AM PT

DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

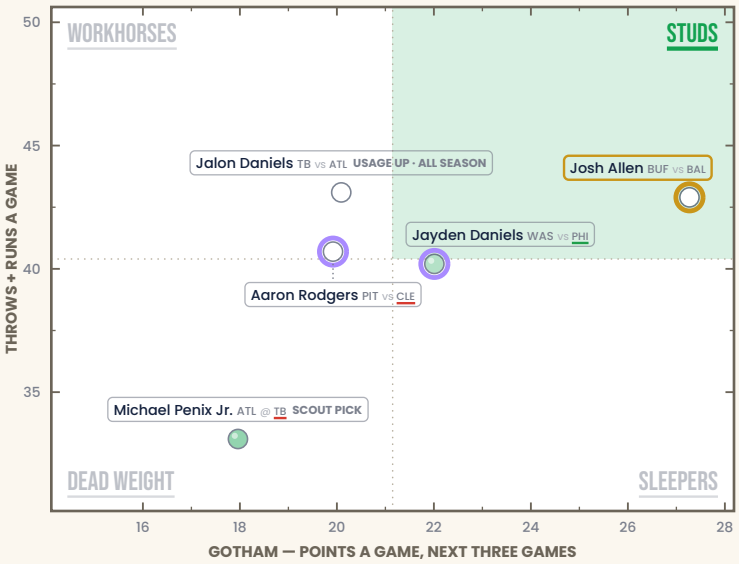
POSITIONS • DK III

Week 8 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

QUARTERBACKS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**

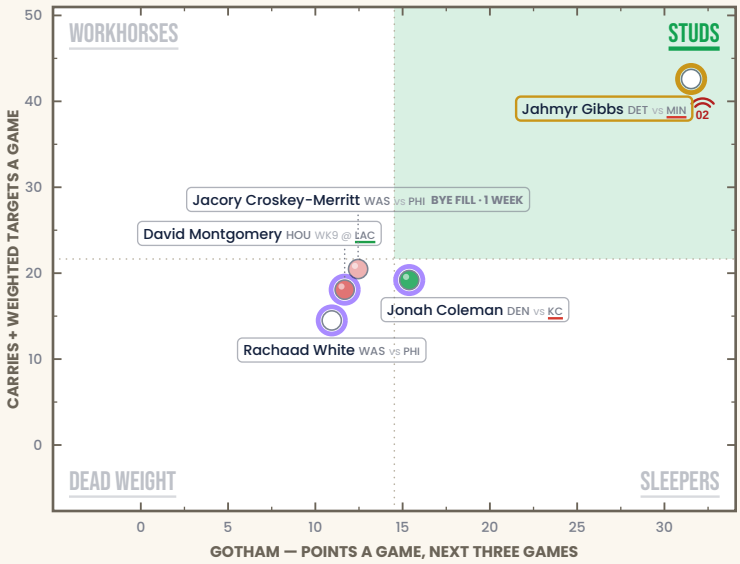


Floor: 18.7 a game — 85% of Jayden Daniels, the weakest starter here (22.0).

Doors: Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2; Michael Penix Jr. — Scout pick — adds ~7 pts through Wk 17

RUNNING BACKS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**

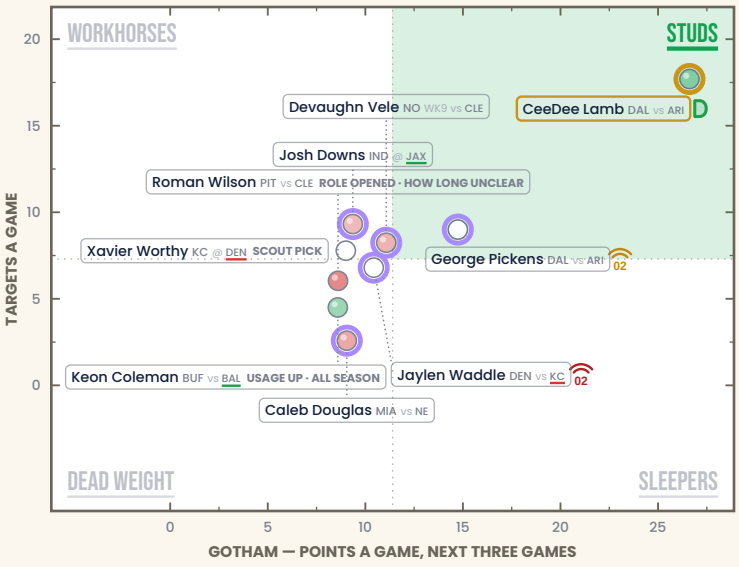


Floor: 9.3 a game — 85% of Rachaad White, the weakest starter here (10.9).

Doors: Jacory Croskey-Merritt — covers Wk10 Jonah Coleman

RECEIVERS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**

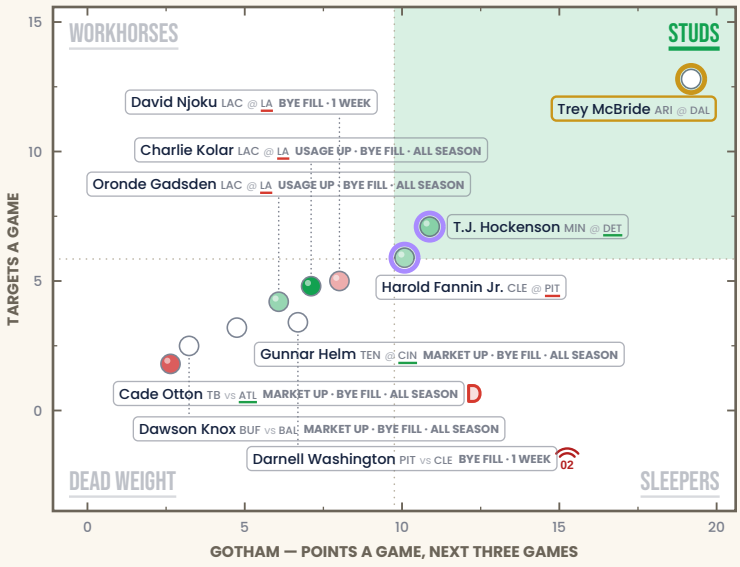


Floor: 8.0 a game — 85% of Josh Downs, the weakest starter here (9.4).

Doors: Keon Coleman — workload 4.0->6.7; Roman Wilson — teammate out: Michael Pittman Jr.; Xavier Worthy — Scout pick — adds ~7 pts through Wk 17

TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 8.6 a game — 85% of Harold Fannin Jr., the weakest starter here (10.1).

Doors: Charlie Kolar — workload 2.3->7.4; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Oronde Gadsden — workload 3.6->7.0; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Gunnar Helm — covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Dawson Knox — covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.

Check: Sleeper far lower than Gotham — Cade Otton 2.6 vs 8.1. Look before acting.

Legend: rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat · violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster

Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page

vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.

Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham

Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · 03 news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · 1 on the Call Sheet

How to read it: Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

SCORECARD

UPCOMING

FAVORED 167.4 to 144.0

Killer Ko-Gees · 5–9, 8th of 10

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

DK IV	167.4
Opp	144.0

Projected margin +23.4 · Yahoo, lineups as set



66% FTN · 67% YAHOO · 66% GOTHAM

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

Players	All 11 starters set, none tagged
Record	8–6 entering Week 8 · median game too
Standing	5th of 10 entering the week · 6th in points

1 2 3 4 **5** 6 | 7 8 9 10

Playoff spots | Playoff line

OUTLOOK

WEEK 8

DK IV goes in as the favorite. Yahoo projects 167.4 to 144.0 against Killer Ko-Gees (5–9, 8th of 10), a 23.4-point edge. Win chance: Yahoo 67%, FTN 66%, Gotham 66%. The three engines agree. At 8–6, 5th of 10: 1 spot inside the playoff line.

Before kickoff. Lineup set, no starter tagged.

Where it's won and lost. Your edges: Robinson over R. Dowdle at RB (+11.2); Jefferson over K. Concepcion Jr. at WR (+7.0). Theirs: B. Bowers over Kraft at TE (-4.0); S. Diggs over Cooper at WR (-2.4). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on Robinson (15.1 vs 20.0) and Jefferson (13.0 vs 17.8) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 8, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 8

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	OPPONENT	SCORE	DELTA
Dak Prescott	1	QB	DAL	QB	vs ARI	14	27.1	22.8	24.8	—	22.6	22.7	J. Burrow	25.8	
Bijan Robinson	1 D ↓	RB	ATL	RB	@ TB	11	20.0	20.5	15.1	—	16.5	20.8	R. Dowdle	8.9	
D'Andre Swift	1 Q20 D	RB	CHI	RB	@ SEA	10	12.7	13.2	12.8	—	18.5	17.5	J. Love	9.5	
Zay Flowers	3	WR	BAL	WR	@ BUF	13	18.4	18.4	18.4	—	17.8	20.4	G. Wilson	15.0	
Justin Jefferson	2	WR	MIN	WR	@ DET	6	17.8	15.2	13.0	—	13.9	14.4	K. Conce…	10.8	
Omar Cooper Jr.	1 ↓	WR	NYJ	WR	vs LV	13	10.1	10.9	10.0	—	15.4	16.3	S. Diggs	12.4	
Tucker Kraft	1 ↑	TE	GB	TE	vs CAR	11	11.7	11.4	11.2	—	11.6	10.2	B. Bowers	15.8	
Ollie Gordon II	1 Q01 ↑	RB	MIA	FLEX	vs NE	6	12.3	11.6	11.8	—	15.8	13.1	E. Egbuka	11.7	
Jared Goff	2 ↓	QB	DET	SFLEX	vs MIN	6	21.1	20.1	20.1	—	23.5	26.8	M. Willis	17.8	
Will Reichard	Q07	K	MIN	K	@ DET	6	8.5	13.2	—	—	—	—	T. Smack	8.7	
Bengals		DEF	CIN	DEF	vs TEN	6	7.7	8.2	—	—	—	—	NE D	7.6	
TOTAL							**167.4**							144.0	

BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
Wan'Dale Robinson	1 ↑	WR	TEN	BN	@ CIN	9	—	8.8	9.8	—	10.6	8.8	Depth at WR · 10.6 next 3
C.J. Stroud	1 ↓	QB	HOU	BN	BYE	8	—	—	—	—	20.6	21.7	On bye · back Wk 9
Travis Kelce	1 ↑	TE	KC	BN	@ DEN	5	—	10.8	9.7	—	11.0	11.7	Covers Kraft's Wk 11 bye
Marvin Harrison Jr.	3 Q05 ↑	WR	ARI	BN	@ DAL	14	—	—	6.1	—	5.5	5.6	Depth at WR · 5.5 next 3
Broncos		WR		BN	BYE	1	—	—	—	—	—	—	On bye · back Wk 9

IR

2 of 3 slots used

PLAYER	MARKERS	POS	TEAM	SLOT	VS	BYE	PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO	FTN	GOTHAM	SCORE	NEXT 3	AVG	VALUE
James Conner INJ IR	1	RB	ARI	IR	@ DAL	14	—	—	—	—	—	—	On IR · holds no roster seat
Isiah Pacheco INJ IR		RB	DET	IR	vs MIN	6	—	—	—	—	—	—	On IR · holds no roster seat
OPEN				IR									Open IR slot

F final **INJ** Yahoo tag **Score** green beat Yahoo by 3+, red 4+ short **Band** playing now **Markers** alert 2 news Q03 Scout need **D** drift ↑ playing time

The Scout is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

Open Seats — 1 IR slot open (only for a player Yahoo lists as IR or Out)

Missing Pieces **A steady second wide receiver** - Jefferson dips once Jordan Addison is back, Downs fades when Alec Pierce returns, and Flowers is off in Week 13
Expert Moves (read Thu Oct 29 2026 3:44 AM PT) no big moves on your roster

Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

The Kicker Spot Won't Hold — K, Season-Long · Target 10.8 pts 07

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~14.0 (Reichard). Wk 9 Reichard ~10.9 (hard matchup vs BUF) · Wk 10 Reichard ~9.7 (hard matchup vs GB) · Wk 11 Reichard ~11.8 · Wk 12 Reichard ~10.9 (hard matchup vs ATL) · Wk 13 Reichard ~11.7 · Wk 14 Reichard ~11.2 · Wk 15 Reichard ~10.0 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 17 Reichard ~10.5 (hard matchup vs NYJ).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

The Flex Won't Hold — FLEX, Season-Long · Target 11.5 pts 01

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~15.7 (Gordon). Wk 8 Gordon ~11.6 · Wk 9 Gordon ~11.6 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 10 Robinson ~10.4 (Gordon moves up to RB2, Robinson slides in) · Wk 11 Cooper ~8.7 (Gordon moves up to RB2, Cooper slides in) · Wk 12 Gordon ~12.0 · Wk 13 Gordon ~12.4 · Wk 14 Gordon ~11.2 (hard matchup vs CHI) · Wk 15 Gordon ~13.1 · Wk 16 Gordon ~12.6.

▶ **Chris Godwin Jr.**, TB WR · Scored 8.3, 8.8, 5.5, 9.1, 7.0, 7.7, 6.7 · Waivers, Clears Oct 30 · Door open: Jalen McMillan out; workload up from 6.9 to 10.3 expected a game; news (RotoBaller, Oct 28): Chris Godwin Jr. Tops Tampa Bay in Targets, but the Production Isn't Following; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Jalen McMillan staying out - check McMillan's status first; rival check: no other team would start him - the minimum bid should do; RATCLIFFE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 9.8 a week vs engine 8.2); helps Wk 9, Wk 11, Wk 13. · **Adds ~11 pts through Wk 17** (3 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your WR3 Omar Cooper Jr.: Ratcliffe 9.1 vs 10.9 · Yahoo 9.8 vs 10.1 · Gotham 10.7 vs 10.0 - mixed - Ratcliffe says worse** · **Fills a missing piece**
Jordan Addison, MIN WR · Scored 0.0, 4.1, 20.0, 9.1, 4.3 · Waivers, Clears Oct 31 · Door closing: Odell Beckham Jr. joined MIN from NYG: his pre-trade ~7.9 a game cut to ~7.5 (4% of the WR production goes to the newcomer); news (RotoBaller, Oct 25): Jordan Addison Continues to Struggle in Week 7; rival check: no other team would start him - the minimum bid should do; BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 10.0, engine 8.8 a week); helps Wk 9. · **Adds ~4 pts through Wk 17** (1 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your WR3 Omar Cooper Jr.: Ratcliffe 9.8 vs 10.9 · Yahoo 9.9 vs 10.1 · Gotham 8.2 vs 10.0 - WORSE this week** · **Fills a missing piece**

The Backfield Runs Thin — RB2, Weeks 8, 10-11 Fill · Target 13.0 pts 20

Drops Off After Wk 11

Full strength ~17.5 (Swift). Wk 8 Swift ~13.2 · Wk 10 Gordon ~12.2 (Swift on bye, Gordon slides in) · Wk 11 Gordon ~13.6 (Swift moves up to RB1, Gordon slides in).

▶ **Omarion Hampton**, LAC RB · Scored 8.3, 17.5, 5.6, 13.3, 4.9, 7.9 · Free Agent · Current level ~10.6 a game; news (RotoBaller, Oct 18): Omarion Hampton is Unable to Find Success in Week 6; BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 10.9, engine 10.4 a week); helps Wk 11. · **Adds ~1 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your FLEX Ollie Gordon II: Ratcliffe 8.4 vs 11.6 · Yahoo 9.8 vs 12.3 · Gotham 10.6 vs 11.8 - WORSE this week**

The Quarterback Spot Runs Thin — QB, Weeks 10, 14 Fill · Target 23.9 pts 20

Drops Off After Wk 14

Full strength ~25.0 (Goff). Wk 10 Goff ~22.5 (hard matchup vs NE) · Wk 14 Stroud ~25.3 (Goff moves up to SUPERFLEX, Stroud slides in).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

Also on the Board WR3, Weeks 9, 11, 13, 15, 17 Fill · WR2, Week 13 Fill · DEF, Week 11 Fill

Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

None this run.

Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

Checked, Not Assumed Can't claim: Josh Downs (IND WR) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Oct 31 and you can add him then. · Stash: Roschon Johnson (CHI RB, free agent) - 32% of the CHI backfield's touches the last three games behind D'Andre Swift (~17.5 a game, 68%); the lead job is his if Swift goes down; his own level now ~5.7 · Stash: Seth McGowan (IND RB, free agent) - 25% of the IND backfield's touches the last three games behind Jonathan Taylor (~20.1 a game, 75%); the lead job is his if Taylor goes down; his own level now ~3.5 · Rising: Jakobi Meyers (JAX WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 21.0 expected points last game from 6.5 before; season level ~9.9, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Davis Allen (LA TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 12.7 expected points last game from 2.6 before; season level ~2.8, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Early warning: Omarion Hampton (LAC RB) snaps 58% to 35% (typical game), touch share 68% to 39% the last three games; Kimani Vidal (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 14% to 38%, touch share 5% to 31%, level now ~8.3 · Early warning: Jonathan Taylor (IND RB) snaps 85% to 73% (typical game), touch share 85% to 75% the last three games; Seth McGowan (free agent) is taking the work - snaps 17% to 28%, touch share 15% to 25%, level now ~3.5 · Colby Parkinson (LA TE) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.9 a game; ranks below the picks above · George Holani (SEA RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Jadarian Price Out; covers Wk10 D'Andre Swift): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~6.3 a game; ranks below the picks above · Jalon Daniels (TB QB) is on the Positions chart (workload 35.8->48.2): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~17.8 a game; ranks below the picks above · Kendre Miller (NO RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate out: Travis Etienne; covers Wk11 Bijan Robinson, Wk10 D'Andre Swift): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~10.2 a game; ranks below the picks above
Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce · Rosters Yahoo Wed Oct 28, 4:56 PM PT · Stats nflverse Thu 3:44 AM PT

DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

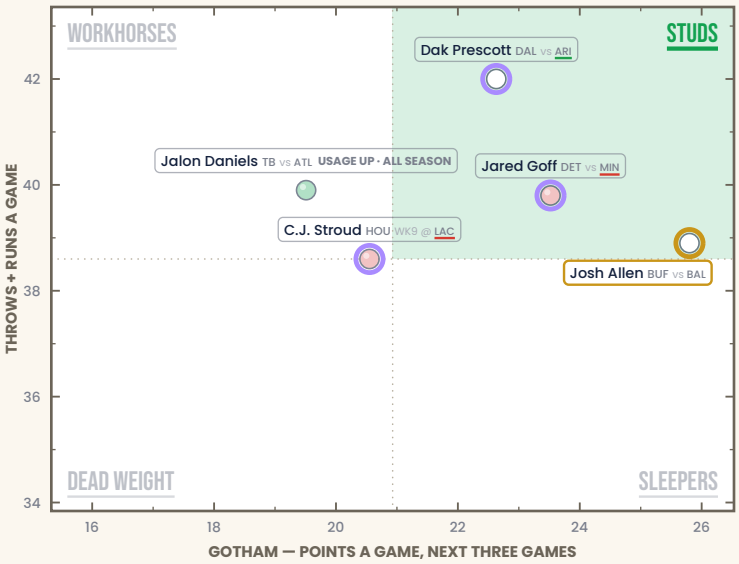
POSITIONS • DK IV

Week 8 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

QUARTERBACKS

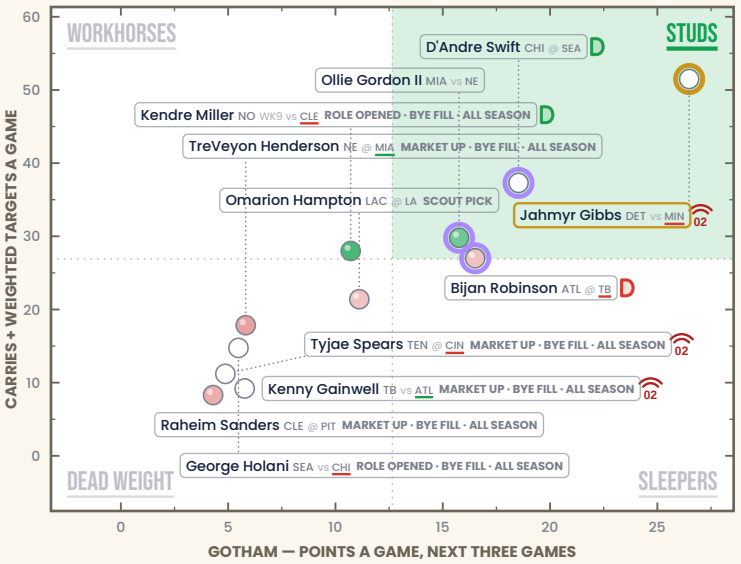
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 19.2 a game — 85% of Dak Prescott, the weakest starter here (22.6).
Doors: Jalon Daniels — workload 35.8->48.2

RUNNING BACKS

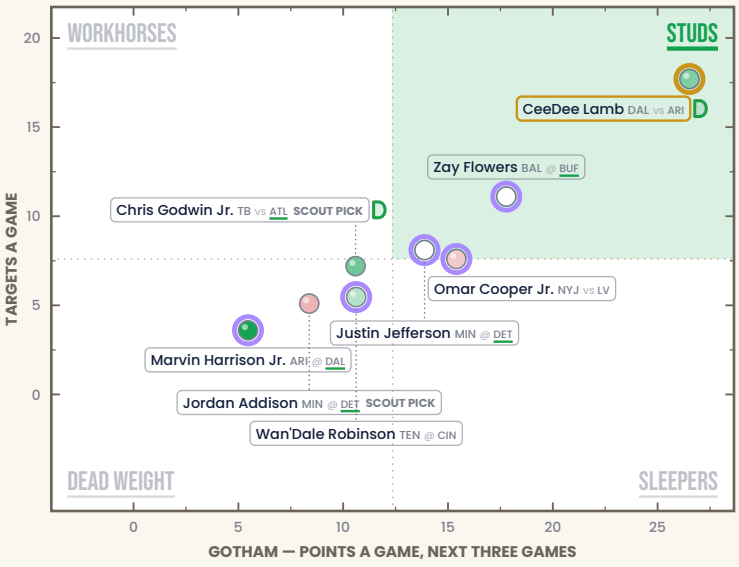
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 13.4 a game — 85% of Ollie Gordon II, the weakest starter here (15.8).
Doors: Kendre Miller — teammate out: Travis Etienne; covers Wk11 Bijan Robinson, Wk10 D'Andre Swift; TreVeyon Henderson — covers Wk10 D'Andre Swift; Kenny Gainwell — covers Wk11 Bijan Robinson; George Holani — teammate down this week: Jadarian Price Out; covers...
Check: Sleeper far lower than Gotham — TreVeyon Henderson 5.8 vs 10.3, Tyjae Spears 4.9 vs 8.2....

RECEIVERS

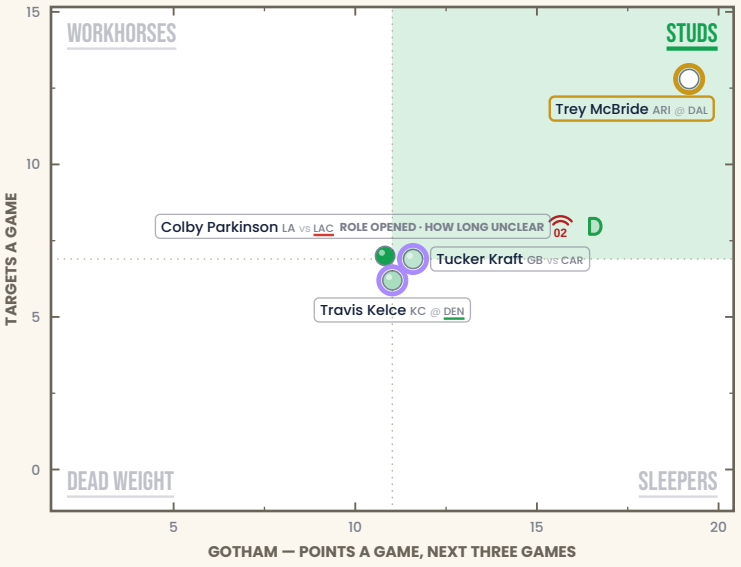
AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 11.8 a game — 85% of Justin Jefferson, the weakest starter here (13.9).
Doors: Chris Godwin Jr. — Scout pick — adds ~11 pts through Wk 17; Jordan Addison — Scout pick — adds ~4 pts through Wk 17

TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **THU OCT. 29, 3:04 AM**



Floor: 9.9 a game — 85% of Tucker Kraft, the weakest starter here (11.6).
Doors: Colby Parkinson — teammate down this week: Terrance Ferguson Out

Legend: rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat
violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster
Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. · SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page
vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.
Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham
Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · on the Call Sheet

How to read it: Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

OVERVIEW · THE MARKS

Week 8 · Every mark at print size · what it means · where...

Data · Wed Oct. 28, 4:53 PM PT

TRIANGLE

Points at the man it concerns and travels with him · bare digit = the Call Sheet item

1	RED	Urgent — look now and act.	Call Sheet, item by number
1	GOLD	Worth doing — monitor, act when the trigger hits.	Call Sheet, item by number
1	GREEN	Confirmed — the move is agreed and dated.	Call Sheet, item by number

THE SIGNAL

The news mark · color = what the news is · digits = days since first seen

04	GREEN	Good news — full practice, off the report, back.	League page, The Radar
04	GOLD	Caution — questionable, limited, or a role change.	League page, The Radar
04	RED	Bad — out, doubtful, or did not practice with an injury.	League page, The Radar
04	GREY	Closed — nothing new; the story has gone quiet.	League page, The Radar
	SPLAT	A man never seen before — first day on the Radar.	League page, The Radar
1/40	1/40	A returner: 1 day back, after a 40-day gap.	League page, The Radar
02	FILLED	Two independent origins confirm it — the rule fired and the number moved.	Reason line under the number
02	HOLLOW	One origin only — arcs hollow, digits solid. No number moves until a second confirms.	Reason line under the number

Origin: the reporter or document a story traces to, not the outlet. Five outlets repeating one beat writer is one origin.

DROP CLUSTER

The cut order itself · there is no cut page · every drop is talked through before it is made

	RED	First to go. Ranked below the number of men rostered at his position.	Field Report bench, Positions
	GOLD	Second to go. Injured men, IR, kickers and defenses are never marked.	Field Report bench, Positions
	GREY	Third to go. A handcuff or the only cover for a bye, Weeks 5-7, never prints red.	Field Report bench, Positions

TREND

Playing time, not points · his last two games against his earlier average · flat = no mark

↗	CLIMBING	Playing time rising.	Field Report, marker column
↘	FALLING	Playing time falling.	Field Report, marker column

D · DRIFT

Gotham changed his number · his role moved over his last two games · look in Gotham

D	D GREEN	Role growing. Takes the trend mark's place on his row.	Marker column, Positions plates
D	D RED	Role shrinking. Comes off on its own once the role settles.	Marker column, Positions plates

TEAM TIER

Hairline on the NFL abbreviation · ranked across all 32 teams by points scored

KC	RULE ABOVE	Top third of the league.	Everywhere a team prints
PIT	RULE BELOW	Bottom third — the whole bad-team warning.	Everywhere a team prints
WAS	CLEAN	Middle third.	Everywhere a team prints

WHY HE'S HERE

Positions page · the words on a free agent's plate · why he is on the chart, what he is for, how long

USAGE UP	His workload last game ran well above his earlier games.	Positions page, on his plate
ROLE OPENED	A teammate ahead of him is out or moved, confirmed.	Positions page, on his plate
ROLE MAY OPEN	Same, but only a missed practice so far, no designation. Watch it.	Positions page, on his plate
MARKET UP	The forecasters rate him well above what Gotham says.	Positions page, on his plate
BYE / INJURY FILL	He beats this roster's best cover for a starter on bye or out, Weeks 8-11.	Positions page, on his plate
ALL SEASON · 3 WEEKS	How long he should help. HOW LONG UNCLEAR when the opening has no end date.	Positions page, on his plate
SCOUT PICK	Recommended on the Scout page, plotted beside the men here.	Positions page, on his plate

THE SCOUT'S SPYGLASS

On the man a live Scout need is about · color = how urgent the need is · the Signal's life cycle: splat, then a day count

03	RED · GOLD	Red = act now, gold = watch. Splat = new today; 03 = three days on.	Field Report, Scout page